

Spotlight indexes almost every sort of data on the system, be it applications, system preferences, documents, folders, mail messages, contacts, events and to do items, images, PDF documents, bookmarks, music, movies, fonts, or presentations. The search results are always sorted according to the type as the default.



Clicking on “Show All” takes you to a neatly designed window

Spotlight brought along with it the ability to have smart folders. Smart folders behave like regular folders, but only contain the aliases of files that match a certain search criterion. These are self-updating folders. So, if you create a smart folder with “apple” as the search term, all your files that contain “apple” will be displayed in the folder. Not just the files, but all the fourteen categories listed above.

A smart folder behaves just like a regular folder, and has the same views and sorting options. There are only two problems with Spotlight: it does not support Boolean operators like Google does; and second, it is so effective that it makes users careless about managing the system!

Windows (even Vista) has always had static shortcuts, while Mac OS X has dynamic aliases (the Mac term for shortcuts). What this means that when you create an alias to a file in Mac OS X, the alias always sticks to the file whether you rename it or relocate it. So it will always launch the file you initially created it for. Even if you move the target file to the trash, the alias on being launched will tell you that it “could not be opened because the original item